

Monday, 10 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 27° 20°	BIRMINGHAM Light drizzle 24° 15°	MANCHESTER Overcast 22° 13°	GLASGOW Overcast 19° 12°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Much of the UK is bracing for a fifth heatwave, with more areas likely to move into official drought status this week.

Forecasters say there's no significant rain on the horizon, meaning the hot, dry spell will continue. This could lead to further restrictions on water use across England.

WEATHER · UK
- 2

The family of a 13-year-old boy killed by a hit-and-run driver say they are 'devastated' by news of his early prison release.

Harley Whiteman died after being struck by a car in 2024. The driver's sentence has now been reduced as part of a government early release scheme, sparking outrage from Harley's loved ones.

JUSTICE · UK
- 3

The early release of two killers of PC Andrew Harper has brought the case of the newlywed officer back into the spotlight.

PC Harper was killed just a month after his wedding, a story that deeply resonated with the public. The decision to release two of those involved has reignited strong feelings about the case.

JUSTICE · UK
- 4

Andy Burnham is embarking on a UK-wide tour to discuss the cost of living crisis, as the Prime Minister defends his own plans.

Number 10 says their proposals will 'give people some room to breathe', but opposition figures are accusing the government of 'hypocrisy'. It's set to be a big talking point this week.

POLITICS · UK
- 5

An attempted murder arrest has been made after three people were hit by a car in Stokes Croft, Bristol.

Police were called to reports of a disturbance before the incident occurred. Investigations are ongoing into what happened.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

1 **After 13 years, Kellie Bright is set to leave EastEnders, meaning her character Linda Carter will depart Walford.**

The actress, who played the popular landlady of The Old Vic, has been a central figure in the soap. Fans will be wondering how her exit storyline will unfold.

ON AIR – What are your favourite Linda Carter memories from her time in Albert Square?

TV · COMING UP

2 **Campaigners are calling for Jared Leto's upcoming UK concerts to be cancelled amid claims of criminal sexual misconduct.**

The musician denies the allegations, but the controversy surrounds his band's performances at two major arenas next year. This could be a developing story for his fans.

ON AIR – With the debate around artists and their pasts, where do you draw the line when it comes to attending their shows?

MUSIC · COMING UP

3 **Digital cameras and wired earphones are making a comeback, with young people embracing older tech for a 'more real' feel.**

Despite being surrounded by advanced technology, there's a growing trend to go back to basics. It seems some are finding charm in the nostalgic and less polished.

ON AIR – Are you someone who's embracing older tech for a bit of nostalgia, or do you always want the latest gadgets?

CULTURE · NOW

4 **Love Island: All Stars winners Molly Smith and Tom Clare have tied the knot, two years after winning the spin-off series.**

The couple, who found love on the first All Stars edition in 2024, have now officially married. It's a happy ending for one of the show's success stories.

ON AIR – Are you surprised by how many Love Island couples actually go the distance and get married?

TV · NOW

5 **Comedian Mo Gilligan says watching Gavin & Stacey brings back 'fond memories' of his childhood holidays at Barry Island.**

The Masked Singer judge reminisces about his visits to Wales, showing how TV shows can evoke strong personal connections. It's a reminder of the show's enduring appeal.

ON AIR – What TV shows instantly transport you back to a particular time or place in your life?

TV · NOW

On the schedule

- 1 Fulham have agreed a £30m fee for Southampton midfielder Shea Charles, subject to a medical.**

This is a significant transfer for the London club as they look to strengthen their squad. Charles will be a key addition if the deal goes through.

ON AIR – Do you think £30m is a fair price for Charles, and what impact do you expect him to have at Fulham?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 2 Manchester United are reportedly working on a deal to sign Leicester teenager Louis Page.**

The young talent from Leicester could be heading to Old Trafford as United continue to invest in youth. It's one to watch for the future.

ON AIR – How important is it for big clubs like Man Utd to continue scouting and developing young British talent?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 3 Britain's Cameron Norrie has exited the Canadian Open in the last 16, alongside world number one Aryna Sabalenka.**

Both players suffered surprise defeats in Toronto, marking an unexpected turn in the tournament. It means we'll see some new faces in the later stages.

ON AIR – With some big names out, who are you tipping to go all the way and win the Canadian Open now?

TENNIS · THIS WEEK
- 4 Manchester United's new £35m signing Youri Tielemans made an impressive debut in a friendly against PSG.**

Tielemans featured in the 1-1 draw in Gothenburg, hinting at a promising future for the midfielder at Old Trafford. Fans will be excited by his early performance.

ON AIR – How much impact do you think Tielemans will have for Manchester United this season?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 5 Sunrisers Leeds have kept their Hundred knockout hopes alive with a six-wicket win over Welsh Fire.**

The victory simultaneously eliminates Welsh Fire from the competition. It was a crucial result that sets up an exciting end to the group stage for the Sunrisers.

ON AIR – With the Hundred heating up, which teams are you backing to make it to the knockout stages?

CRICKET · UK

Quick hits

- 1 The joy of 'porch presents' is bringing back old-fashioned neighbourhood cheer.**
People are leaving anonymous small gifts on neighbours' doorsteps, from homegrown vegetables to homemade biscuits, simply to brighten someone's day. It's creating a lovely ripple effect of goodwill.
- 2 A new trend sees people embracing 'micro-adventures' in their own back gardens.**
Think camping out under the stars, building a den, or even having a themed picnic. It's about finding adventure close to home and making the most of your outdoor space.
- 3 The unexpected charm of 'vintage board games' is seeing a resurgence in popularity.**
Families and friends are rediscovering classic games like Cluedo and Monopoly, preferring their tactile nature and social interaction over screen-based entertainment. Dust off those boxes!
- 4 Experts are highlighting the calming benefits of 'slow cooking' for well-being.**
The gentle bubbling, the rich aromas, and the anticipation of a delicious meal are proving to be wonderfully therapeutic. It's a mindful approach to meal preparation.
- 5 The humble 'houseplant' is becoming a focal point for home decor, beyond just greenery.**
People are choosing plants for their unique foliage, colours, and even their interesting shadows, turning them into living works of art within their homes. It's botanical interior design!
- 6 A study suggests that 'looking at old photographs' can significantly boost mood and memory.**
Taking time to flick through physical photo albums or digital archives helps connect us with positive past experiences and loved ones. It's a simple joy that's good for the soul.
- 7 There's a growing appreciation for the soothing sound of 'rain on a windowpane'.**
Many are finding the gentle drumming of rain to be incredibly relaxing, aiding concentration or helping them drift off to sleep. Nature's own white noise machine.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to figure out if something in the fridge is still good to eat, even if we know it's a bit of a risk?

ANSWER: GIVING IT A QUICK SNIFF, EVEN IF IT'S ALREADY PAST ITS BEST-BEFORE DATE!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a lovely, fresh slice of cake. What is it?

ANSWER: ENSURING THE SLICE IS PERFECTLY CUT, EVEN IF IT MEANS TIDYING UP THE CRUMBS FIRST!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you stumble upon a 'hidden gem' in your local area, something really charming you never knew was there?**

What's a local 'hidden gem' you've discovered, maybe a lovely little independent shop, a quiet park bench with a view, or a tucked-away café, that you absolutely adore and would recommend?

- **We all have those 'unwritten rules' in our family that everyone just knows, even if they've never been officially stated, don't we?**

What's an 'unwritten rule' in your family that's a bit quirky, or perhaps makes perfect sense to you but might seem odd to an outsider?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **History.** Did you know that in Ancient Rome, purple dye was so expensive that only emperors and very high-ranking officials were allowed to wear it?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that the first-ever traffic light in Britain was installed in London in 1868, but it was gas-powered and sadly exploded after only a month?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- The world's first successful photograph was taken in 1826 by Joseph Nicéphore Niépce.
- Bananaphobia is the fear of bananas.
- The Great Wall of China is not visible from space with the naked eye.
- The 'sixth sick sheik's sixth sheep's sick' is believed to be the toughest tongue twister in the English language.
- The smallest bone in the human body is the stapes (or stirrup bone) in the ear.
- Wombat faeces are cube-shaped.
- The first modern Olympic Games were held in Athens, Greece, in 1896.

On this day

Day 222 of the year, 143 days left in 2026. Today Argentine Air Force Day (Argentina); Christian feast day: Bessus; Christian feast day: Blane (Roman Catholic Church); Christian feast day: Geraint of Dumnonia. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1984 — Jigar Naik, English cricketer
- 1972 — Lawrence Dallaglio, English rugby player and sportscaster
- 1971 — Roy Keane, Irish footballer and manager
- 1931 — Tom Laughlin, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter (died 2013)
- 1956 — Charlie Peacock, American singer-songwriter, pianist, and producer
- 1972 — Angie Harmon, American model and actress
- 1968 — Michael Bivins, American singer and producer
- 1978 — Chris Read, English cricketer

THE DAY TODAY

- 2001 — The 2001 Angola train attack occurred, causing 252 deaths.
- 1988 — Japanese American internment: U.S. President Ronald Reagan signs the Civil Liberties Act of 1988, providing \$20,000 payments to Japanese Americans who were either interned in or relocated by the United States during World War II.
- 1978 — Three members of the Ulrich family are killed in an accident. This leads to the Ford Pinto litigation.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2003 — The Okinawa Urban Monorail is opened in Naha, Okinawa.
- 2020 — Derecho in Iowa becomes the most costly thunderstorm disaster in U.S. history.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2014 — Forty people are killed when Sepahan Airlines Flight 5915 crashes at Tehran's Mehrabad International Airport.
- 1961 — Vietnam War: The U.S. Army begins Operation Ranch Hand, spraying an estimated 20 million US gallons (76,000 m3) of defoliants and herbicides over rural areas of South Vietnam in an attempt to deprive the Viet Cong of food and vegetation cover.

- 1977 — In Yonkers, New York, 24-year-old postal employee David Berkowitz ("Son of Sam") is arrested for a series of killings in the New York City area over the period of one year.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 223 of the year, 142 days left in 2026. Today Christian Feast Day: Athracht; Christian Feast Day: Clare of Assisi; Christian Feast Day: Gaugericus; Christian Feast Day: John Henry Newman (Church of England). Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1968 — Anna Gunn, American actress
- 1970 — Andy Bell, British musician and songwriter
- 1954 — Joe Jackson, English singer-songwriter and musician
- 1957 — Ian Stuart Donaldson, English singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 1993)
- 1942 — Mike Hugg, English drummer and keyboard player
- 1985 — Asher Roth, American rapper
- 1925 — Arlene Dahl, American actress, businesswoman and writer (died 2021)
- 1971 — Tommy Mooney, English footballer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1969 — The Apollo 11 astronauts are released from a three-week quarantine following their liftoff from the Moon.
- 2003 — NATO takes over command of the peacekeeping force in Afghanistan, marking its first major operation outside Europe in its 54-year-history.
- 1995 — The Russell Hill subway accident in Toronto kills 3 and injures 30, due to a combination of human error and a safety system design flaw.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2023 — Luna 25 launches from the Vostochny Cosmodrome.
- 2000 — An air rage incident occurs on board Southwest Airlines Flight 1763 when 19-year-old Jonathan Burton attempts to storm the cockpit, but he is subdued by other passengers and dies from his injuries.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)